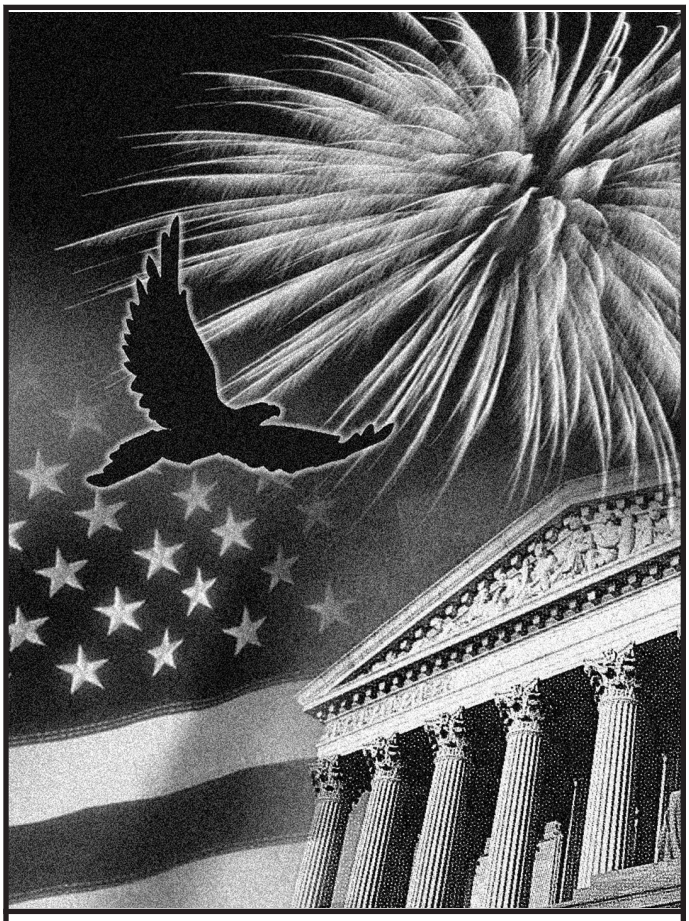
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Household Employer's Tax Guide

For use in **2017**



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Future Developments

For the latest information about developments related to Pub. 926, such as legislation enacted after it was published, go to *IRS.gov/pub926*.

What's New

Social security and Medicare tax for 2017. The social security tax rate is 6.2% each for the employee and employer, unchanged from 2016. The social security wage base limit is $127,200.

The Medicare tax rate is 1.45% each for the employee and employer, unchanged from 2016. There is no wage base limit for Medicare tax. Social security and Medicare taxes apply to the wages of household employees you pay $2,000 or more in cash in 2017. For more information, see *Cash wages*, later.

Qualified parking exclusion and commuter transportation benefit. For 2017, the monthly exclusion for qualified parking is $255 and the monthly exclusion for commuter highway vehicle transportation and transit passes is $255.

New certification program for professional employer organizations. The Tax Increase Prevention Act of 2014

Table 1. **Do You Need To Pay Employment Taxes?**

IF you ...		THEN you need to ...
A–	Pay cash wages of $2,000 or more in 2017 to any one household employee. Don't count wages you pay to— • Your spouse, • Your child under the age of 21, • Your parent (see *Wages not counted*, later, for an exception), or • Any employee under the age of 18 at any time in 2017 (see *Wages not counted*, later, for an exception).	Withhold and pay social security and Medicare taxes. • The taxes are 15.3%[1] of cash wages. • Your employee's share is 7.65%[1]. (You can choose to pay it yourself and not withhold it.) • Your share is 7.65%.
B–	Pay total cash wages of $1,000 or more in any calendar quarter of 2016 or 2017 to household employees. Don't count wages you pay to— • Your spouse, • Your child under the age of 21, or • Your parent.	Pay federal unemployment tax. • The tax is 6% of cash wages. • Wages over $7,000 a year per employee aren't taxed. • You also may owe state unemployment tax.
[1] In addition to withholding Medicare tax at 1.45%, you must withhold a 0.9% Additional Medicare Tax from wages you pay to an employee in excess of $200,000 in a calendar year. You're required to begin withholding Additional Medicare Tax in the pay period in which you pay wages in excess of $200,000 to an employee and continue to withhold it each pay period until the end of the calendar year. Additional Medicare Tax is only imposed on the employee. There is no employer share of Additional Medicare Tax. All wages that are subject to Medicare tax are subject to Additional Medicare Tax withholding if paid in excess of the $200,000 withholding threshold.		
Note. If neither A nor B above applies, you don't need to pay any federal employment taxes. But you may still need to pay state employment taxes.		

Table 2. **Household Employer's Checklist**

You may need to do the following things when you have a household employee.

When you hire a household employee:	☐ Find out if the person can legally work in the United States. ☐ Find out if you need to withhold and pay federal taxes. ☐ Find out if you need to withhold and pay state taxes.
When you pay your household employee:	☐ Withhold social security and Medicare taxes. ☐ Withhold federal income tax. ☐ Decide how you will make tax payments. ☐ Keep records.
By January 31, 2018:	☐ Get an employer identification number (EIN). ☐ Give your employee Copies B, C, and 2 of Form W-2, Wage and Tax Statement. ☐ Send Copy A of Form W-2 with Form W-3 to the Social Security Administration (SSA). Don't send Form W-2 to the SSA if you didn't withhold federal income tax and the social security and Medicare wages were below $2,000 for 2017.
By April 17, 2018:	☐ File Schedule H (Form 1040), Household Employment Taxes, with your 2017 federal income tax return (Form 1040, 1040NR, 1040-SS, or 1041). If you don't have to file a return, file Schedule H by itself.

TIP *If you don't need to pay social security, Medicare, or federal unemployment tax and don't choose to withhold federal income tax, read* State employment taxes *next. The rest of this publication doesn't apply to you.*

State employment taxes. You should contact your state unemployment tax agency to find out whether you need to pay state unemployment tax for your household employee. For a list of state unemployment tax agencies, visit the U.S. Department of Labor's website at *workforcesecurity.doleta.gov/unemploy/agencies.asp*. You should also determine if you need to pay or collect other state employment taxes or carry workers' compensation insurance.

Consequences of not paying employment taxes. If you have a household employee and you're required to withhold and pay employment taxes and you don't, you will generally be liable for the employment taxes that you should've withheld and paid. See section 2 in Pub. 15 for additional information. Interest and penalties may also be charged. You may have to pay a penalty if you don't give Forms W-2 to your employees or file Copy A of the forms with the SSA by the due dates. You may also have to pay a penalty if you don't show your employee's SSN on Form W-2 or don't provide correct information on the form.